

Self-Assessment Checklist (R&D)

Your Role:

- **R&D** producing work inputs **towards production** of client workshop materials, including facilitation guide, etc.

Your Audience w/r/t this **Self-Assessment Checklist** document:

- Primary - **Mellonhead Instructional Design or Facilitators** that will leverage research materials to produce final client deliverables (workshop deck, resource, etc)
- Secondary - Mellonhead enterprise **client end users** who will consume workshop materials

How To Use This Document:

- **Review checklist** for quick evaluation of activity research before submitting to Mariena

Perspective

- ☐ **Audience:** Content is framed for a **client** audience (rather than a fellow researcher)
- ☐ **Accessibility:** Does not assume expert level of technical know-how and/or AI familiarity. Someone who's **never used ChatGPT** can follow along.

Design

- ☐ **Backward design:** It is clear what **behaviors** the activity aims to **change**, and what attendees **should be able to do** when they walk out of the workshop. **Learning outcomes** > content coverage.
- ☐ **Setup:** If there are any **prerequisite steps** a participant would need to complete before starting this activity, **context-setting** or preparatory actions have been provided or documented.
- ☐ **Limitations:** Scenarios where the primary approach may **not work as expected** has been considered and/or tested.
- ☐ **Approach:** Multiple approaches to the activity have been considered, including **variations** of how participants might engage with or complete it.
- ☐ **Checks:** Where possible, **validation steps** or test prompts a participant can use to check they're **on the right track** before executing a prompt or completing the activity are included.

Testing

- ☐ **Validation:** Example prompts/exercises/activities were validated with **actual data** (ideally real client data). Workshop attendees **should not be** conducting any exercise that **hasn't been manually tested** by a Mellonhead researcher and/or facilitator.
- ☐ **Realistic Timing:** Activities should take **no longer than 20 minutes** to complete. If there are **multiple steps** to walk workshop attendees through, consider **paring down scope** and/or saving for **nested cards**.
- ☐ **When things go wrong:** Did you document what didn't work during testing - not just the solution, but the failure? For each Pro Tip or workaround, can you trace it back to a specific thing that went wrong and what you tried to fix it?

What “Done” Looks Like (universal)

- ☐ **Expected formatting and structure:** Headers present, components follow template order, no missing fields
- ☐ **Consistent tone and level of detail:** Language stays at practitioner level throughout - no sections that are overly academic or underdeveloped relative to others
- ☐ **Clear themes and message:** A reviewer can easily identify the activity's **core value prop**
- ☐ **Submission is scannable:** No dense prose blocks. Use of bullets, headers, or other clear **visual hierarchy**
- ☐ **Executable guidance:** Participants are clear on what to do and why - **activities are not just academic or conceptual**

Activity Research: What “Done” Looks Like

- ☐ Includes **specific prompt(s)** for a facilitator to use
 - ☐ Prompt has been **tested with client tool stack** and **data**
- ☐ Includes **pro tips** that help participants get better results (e.g., how to structure a prompt, refine a follow-up, handle edge cases)
 - ☐ Where possible includes brief explanation of **why a tip or approach works** - not just what to do
- ☐ **Source citations:** Research findings are cited properly throughout and formatted appropriately
- ☐ **Control/Test Prompts:** Where relevant, both a control prompt and test prompt are present, each with a sample response to demonstrate the “alpha” of the Mellonhead approach